Indian Institute of Management, Calcutta

Course Outline: Digital & Social Media Marketing — MK-265 (2025-26)

Course: Digital & Social Media Marketing (MK-265)

Term: VI, MBA61 (2026)

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Credits: 3

Elective Cap: 60

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1. Introduction & Course Rationale

This course immerses students in the dynamic world of digital and social media marketing, emphasizing hands-on learning to prepare them as future leaders, managers, and marketers. Through practical exposure to digital transformation, data-driven decision-making, and the rising influence of AI and social platforms, students will master emerging trends such as generative AI, influencer analytics, social commerce, and social listening. The curriculum focuses on integrating online and offline strategies, understanding consumer journeys, and achieving measurable ROI. By engaging with real-world tools and scenarios, students will develop the skills and confidence needed to excel in tomorrow's marketing landscape.

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2. Course Objectives & Outcomes

The students learn how to leverage Digital and Social Media marketing to drive ROI. Participants will
be well-versed in evaluating digital and social media marketing activities. Students learn the nuances
of integrating technology, creativity, and innovation to engage customers and drive business growth.

Students indulge in in-class activities and learn the best industry practices. Students will be able to

- Map the digital & social media landscape (owned / paid / earned)
- Use SEO, SEM, and AI-driven advertising tools
- Design inbound strategies (content, social, communities)
- Plan influencer & viral campaigns using analytics
- Leverage social listening, trend mining, sentiment analysis
- Measure performance via analytics dashboards & KPIs
- Manage ethical, privacy, and bias considerations in AI marketing
- Integrate digital + traditional channels in holistic campaigns
- Understand social media communities and their networks

Programme-Level Learning Objectives

1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organizational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations

2. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century

3. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same

4. Acquire the capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings

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3. Evaluation Scheme

Component	Weight
End-term Exam	30%
Group Project	30%
Individual Assignment / Quiz / Case Write-ups	20%
Class Participation / Mini quizzes	20%

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4. Session-wise Plan (2025 Upgraded) & Case Assignments

MODULE I – Digital Transformation & AI-Driven Marketing

Explore how AI, data, and automation are transforming digital marketing ecosystems. Learn to design integrated campaigns using SEO, SEM, paid media, Google Ads, and responsive websites. Understand personalization algorithms and the role of analytics in optimizing digital spend.

MODULE II – Inbound & Social Media Marketing

Business priorities are changing – marketers are becoming profit centers. So, it's critical to understand how brands attract and retain audiences using AI-enabled storytelling, social engagement, and content strategy. Learn to design consumer journeys, build personas, and measure emotional resonance. Gain hands-on exposure to campaign automation and sentiment analytics.

MODULE III – Influencer, Viral & Community Marketing

Dive into influencer ecosystems and the science of virality. Evaluate how digital communities co-create brands, drive advocacy, and shape public opinion. Study metrics for authenticity, reach, and ROI while analyzing AI-driven influencer discovery and fraud detection.

MODULE IV – Analytics & Performance Measurement

Develop analytical fluency in measuring campaign performance. Learn attribution modeling, KPI dashboards, and predictive analytics using GA4 and AI tools. Evaluate ROI, engagement, and lifetime value to make data-driven marketing decisions.

Session wise breakup is as below:

Sessions	Theme / Focus	Key Topics & Tools	HBS Case / Reading
1–2	Digital Transformation & Platforms	Media types, touchpoints, ecosystem view	*Reading:* "10 Principles of Modern Marketing" (foundation)
3–5	Search, AI & Advertising	SEM, SEO, algorithmic ad auctions, AI in ad targeting	*Case:* "Enhancing the Amazon Alexa Conversation with Ads" — HBS Case **824-111** *Case: "HubSpot and the AI Content Revolution"* (hypothetical, to be procured / adapted)
6–7	Inbound Strategy & Consumer Engagement	GenAI content, UGC, social content workflows	*Content & SEO Lab* - students will use a tool like Semrush or Ahrefs (even a trial version) to perform keyword research and analyze a competitor's content strategy.
8–9	Communities & Brand Advocacy	Forum dynamics, co-creation, trust, social listening	*Case: "LEGO Ideas: Harnessing Community Creativity"* (to be procured / adapted)
10–11	Influencer / Viral Marketing	Micro vs macro influencers, network propagation, analytics	*Case:* "Glossier: Co-Creating a Cult Brand with a Digital Community" — HBS Case **519-022**
12	Content Marketing & Workflow	Editorial calendars, modular content, multichannel design	—
13–14	Strategy, Execution & Visualization	Goal mapping, platform choice, campaign structure	*Case: "Bazaar.com – Measuring ROI on Sponsored Search Ads"* (retain classic case or adapt)
15–17	Analytics & Performance Measurement	GA4, AI dashboards, attribution modeling, AB testing	*Case: "Netflix Marketing Analytics: AI for Personalization and Retention"* (to be procured / adapted) *GA4 & Visualization Lab* - where students work with a demo Google Analytics account to build a custom dashboard or track a conversion funnel.

Sessions	Theme / Focus	Key Topics & Tools	HBS Case / Reading
18–20	Project Presentations & Reflection	Group project presentation, peer review, class discussion	—

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5. Suggested Readings & Supplements (2025 Edition)

- **Required Textbook:** Alan Charlesworth, *Digital Marketing: A Practical Approach* (4th Ed)
- **Supplementary / Reference Texts:**
  - *The AI Marketing Canvas* by Raj Venkatesan & Jim Lesinski
  - *Human + Machine* by Paul Daugherty & H. James Wilson
- **Articles / Papers:**
  - "Sponsored is the New Organic: Implications of Sponsored Results on Quality of Search Results in the Amazon Marketplace" (2024) — ab out algorithms & ads
  - Reports on algorithmic collusion in pricing & advertising (2025)
